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NEXORA TECHNOLOGIES PRIVATE LIMITED

EMPLOYEE HR POLICY HANDBOOK

(Part 1 of 3 - Sections 1 to 5)

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Applies To : All employees of Nexora Technologies Pvt. Ltd. in India

Classification : Internal - For Employee Use

NOTE: This handbook is a fictional sample created for demonstration and testing purposes only. Nexora Technologies Pvt. Ltd. is not a real company.

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1. INTRODUCTION AND SCOPE

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1.1 Purpose

This handbook sets out the policies, benefits and expectations that apply to every employee of Nexora Technologies Pvt. Ltd. ("Nexora", "the Company"). Its aim is to make sure that employees are treated fairly and consistently and that

they understand their rights and responsibilities.

1.2 Applicability

This policy applies to all full-time, part-time, fixed-term and probationary employees. Interns, consultants and third-party contractors are covered only by the sections that specifically mention them (mainly Sections 8, 9 and 12).

1.3 Relationship with Other Documents

Where this handbook conflicts with an individual employment contract, the contract prevails. Where it conflicts with applicable law (for example, the Maternity Benefit Act, 1961 or the Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972), the law prevails. Department-level guidelines may add to, but never reduce, the entitlements described here.

1.4 Equal Opportunity

Nexora is an equal opportunity employer. Hiring, promotion, compensation and termination decisions are made without discrimination on the basis of gender, caste, religion, age, disability, marital status, sexual orientation or any other characteristic protected by law.

2. EMPLOYMENT CATEGORIES AND WORKING HOURS

2.1 Employment Categories

- (a) Full-Time Employee: Works a minimum of 45 hours per week and is eligible for all benefits in this handbook.
- (b) Part-Time Employee: Works fewer than 30 hours per week. Leave and benefits are provided on a pro-rata basis. Part-time employees are not eligible for the group health insurance policy unless required by law.
- (c) Fixed-Term Employee: Hired for a defined period. Benefits are the same as full-time employees for the duration of the contract.
- (d) Probationer: A newly hired full-time employee who has not yet been confirmed (see Section 3).

2.2 Working Days and Hours

The standard work week is Monday to Friday. Standard working hours are 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM, which includes a one-hour lunch break, giving eight productive hours per day. Saturdays and Sundays are weekly offs.

2.3 Core Hours

Employees are expected to be available for meetings and collaboration between 11:00 AM and 4:00 PM (IST), regardless of their exact start time. Managers may approve flexible start times between 8:00 AM and 10:30 AM.

2.4 Overtime and Compensatory Off

Employees in grades L1 to L3 who are required to work on a weekly off or a public holiday are entitled to compensatory off ("comp-off"). One full day of work earns one comp-off day; work of four hours or less earns half a day. Comp-offs must be approved in advance by the reporting manager and must be availed within 60 days of the date worked, failing which they lapse. Comp-offs are not encashable. Employees in grades L4 and above are not eligible for overtime or comp-off.

3. PROBATION, CONFIRMATION AND NOTICE PERIOD

3.1 Probation Period

All new employees are placed on probation for six (6) months from the date of joining. Probation may be extended by up to three (3) additional months if performance or conduct needs improvement. The extension must be communicated in writing before the original probation period ends.

3.2 Confirmation

Confirmation is based on a written evaluation by the reporting manager, reviewed by the HR Business Partner (HRBP). A confirmation letter is issued within 15 working days of the end of probation. If no letter is issued, the employee should contact their HRBP; silence does not imply confirmation.

3.3 Notice Period

- (a) During probation: 15 days' written notice by either party.
- (b) After confirmation, grades L1 to L3: 60 days' written notice.
- (c) After confirmation, grades L4 and above: 90 days' written notice.

3.4 Notice Period Buyout

An employee may request an early release by paying the basic salary for the unserved portion of the notice period (a "buyout"). Buyout is at the sole discretion of the Company and is not available to employees who are under a disciplinary inquiry or who hold critical client responsibilities. Where the Company waives part of the notice period, no recovery will be made.

3.5 Leave During Notice Period

Employees serving notice may not take casual leave or earned leave without prior approval from their manager and HRBP. Any leave taken during the notice period that is not approved will extend the notice period by an equal number of days.

4. LEAVE POLICY

4.1 Leave Year

The leave year runs from 1 January to 31 December. Leave entitlements for employees who join mid-year are calculated pro-rata from the date of joining.

4.2 Summary of Leave Entitlements

Leave Type	Days per Year	Carry Forward	Encashable
Casual Leave (CL)	8	No	No
Sick Leave (SL)	8	No	No
Earned Leave (EL)	18	Yes, up to 45	Yes, on separation
Optional Holidays	2	No	No
Marriage Leave	5 (once)	Not applicable	No
Bereavement Leave	5 per event	Not applicable	No

4.3 Casual Leave

Casual leave is meant for short, unplanned personal needs. A maximum of three (3) consecutive days of casual leave may be taken at a time. Casual leave cannot be combined with earned leave to form a continuous absence longer than seven (7) calendar days without the manager's approval. Unused casual leave lapses on 31 December.

4.4 Sick Leave

Sick leave is for the employee's own illness or medical treatment. A medical certificate from a registered practitioner is required if sick leave exceeds two (2) consecutive working days. Sick leave taken immediately before or after a public holiday or weekend requires a medical certificate irrespective of duration. Unused sick leave lapses on 31 December.

4.5 Earned Leave (Privilege Leave)

Earned leave accrues at 1.5 days per month of service (18 days per year). Earned leave can be availed only after confirmation. Planned earned leave of five (5) or more consecutive days should be applied for at least 15 days in advance. An employee may accumulate a maximum of 45 days of earned leave; accrual stops once the balance reaches 45 days. On separation, the unused earned leave balance is encashed at the rate of basic salary divided by 26 per day.

4.6 Public Holidays and Optional Holidays

The Company declares 10 public holidays each year, published on the HR portal in December of the preceding year. In addition, each employee may choose up to two (2) optional holidays from a list of six published festivals. Optional holidays must be selected on the HR portal at least seven days in advance.

4.7 Maternity Leave

Female employees are entitled to maternity leave under the Maternity Benefit Act, 1961 (as amended in 2017):

- 26 weeks of paid leave for the first two children (up to 8 weeks may be taken before the expected date of delivery).
- 12 weeks of paid leave for the third child onward.
- 12 weeks of paid leave for a mother who legally adopts a child under three months of age, or a commissioning mother.
- Up to six (6) weeks of paid leave in case of miscarriage or medical termination of pregnancy, on production of a medical certificate.

To be eligible, the employee must have worked for at least 80 days in the 12 months preceding the expected date of delivery. After maternity leave, the Company offers up to 12 weeks of work-from-home on request, subject to the nature of the role. Nexora also provides a crèche subsidy of INR 6,000 per month per child (up to age three) for employees who do not have access to the on-site crèche.

4.8 Paternity Leave

Male employees are entitled to 10 working days of paid paternity leave for the birth or adoption of a child. It must be availed within six (6) months of the date of birth or adoption and cannot be split into more than two blocks.

4.9 Marriage Leave

Employees are entitled to five (5) days of paid marriage leave, available once during the tenure of employment, for the employee's own marriage. It must be taken within 30 days before or 60 days after the wedding date.

4.10 Bereavement Leave

In the event of the death of an immediate family member (spouse, child, parent, sibling, parent-in-law or grandparent), the employee is entitled to five (5) days of paid bereavement leave per event. Additional days may be taken from earned or casual leave balance.

4.11 Loss of Pay (LOP)

Absence without approved leave, or absence after the leave balance is exhausted, is treated as Loss of Pay. One day's LOP is deducted as monthly gross salary divided by the number of calendar days in that month. Three (3) or more consecutive days of unauthorised absence may be treated as "absconding" and can lead to disciplinary action under Section 10.

4.12 Applying for Leave

All leave must be applied for on the HR portal (PeopleHub). Emergency leave may be informed by phone or message to the manager on the day of absence, with the leave request regularised on the portal within two working days of returning to work.

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5. HYBRID WORK AND ATTENDANCE POLICY

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5.1 Hybrid Model

Nexora follows a hybrid model. Employees in office-eligible roles are expected to work from the office for a minimum of three (3) days per week. The designated anchor days are Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday. Employees may work from home on Mondays and Fridays with prior intimation to the manager.

5.2 Work From Anywhere (WFA)

Each employee may work from a location other than their registered city for up to 20 working days per calendar year, subject to manager approval at least 10 working days in advance. WFA is not available during probation, during a performance improvement plan, or during the notice period. Employees working from outside India are not permitted under this policy because of tax and compliance considerations.

5.3 Home Office Allowance

Employees who work from home receive a monthly home-office allowance of INR 1,000 towards internet and utilities. Employees who are on a fully remote contract receive an additional one-time setup allowance of INR 15,000.

5.4 Attendance Recording

Attendance is recorded through biometric entry in the office and through the PeopleHub check-in on work-from-home days. An employee who logs fewer than four (4) hours on a working day will be marked as half-day; fewer than two (2) hours will be marked as absent. Three (3) late arrivals of more than 30 minutes in a month will be counted as one half-day of casual leave.

5.5 Exceptions

Employees with a documented medical condition, or those returning from maternity leave, may request an exemption from anchor days by writing to their HRBP.

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